



WASHINGTON, DC CIVIC JOURNEY · 8TH GRADE · APRIL 14 TO 18, 2027

Family Trip Brief

The family letter, the five days at a glance, how students are supervised, the packing list, the student agreement, and the permission slip and health update to return to the school office with the deposit by Friday, February 26.

TRIP DATES	COST	RETURN BY	INFORMATION NIGHT
Wednesday to Sunday April 14 to 18, 2027	\$875 per student	Friday February 26	Thursday, January 14 6:30 p.m., Middle School commons
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Washington, DC Civic Journey

8th grade · Wednesday, April 14 through Sunday, April 18, 2027

TRIP DATES

April 14 to 18
Wednesday to
Sunday

REPORT TO SCHOOL

4:30 a.m.
Wednesday

BACK AT SCHOOL

5:45 to 6:15 a.m.
Sunday

COST

\$875
per student

PERMISSION SLIP AND DEPOSIT DUE

Friday
February 26

Dear 8th Grade Families,

From Wednesday, April 14 to Sunday, April 18, the 8th grade will travel to Washington, DC. Over three full days in the capital, students will take part in an educator-led program at the National Archives, tour the U.S. Capitol, visit the Library of Congress, spend a day at the National Museum of African American History and Culture and the National Museum of American History, walk the memorials on the National Mall at dusk, visit Arlington National Cemetery, and study leadership at the National Portrait Gallery.

We travel by charter bus with Lakefront Student Transportation. The bus leaves school at 5:00 a.m. Wednesday and arrives at our hotel, the Holiday Inn Washington—College Park in Maryland, in the early afternoon. We stay three nights. On Saturday evening a second, rested driver team takes over for the overnight ride home, with four rest stops, and we expect to be back at school between 5:45 and 6:15 a.m. Sunday.

Six staff members travel with the group, one for every five students: Marcus Lee, Rachel Morgan, RN, our school nurse, Olivia Bennett, Daniel Kim, Aisha Thompson and me. Each student stays with the same chaperone group for the whole trip. Please read the travel, hotel, packing and health information on the next two pages with your student, then return the permission slip and deposit by Friday, February 26. We will answer questions at the trip information night on Thursday, January 14, at 6:30 p.m. in the Middle School commons.



The National Mall from the Lincoln Memorial

What students will learn

The trip is the fieldwork for our 8th grade civics unit, *Democracy in Place*. Students carry one question all week: how does a democracy make decisions, preserve evidence, include voices and remember its past? At each site they collect one piece of evidence in a field journal, and after the trip they use evidence from at least three sites to write an argued response or pitch a civic exhibit.

Questions: Emily Carter · 216-555-0164 · trips@horizonridge.example. While the group is away, Jordan Patel, Head of Middle School, is the contact at school: 216-555-0142.

Sincerely,

Emily Carter · Middle School Science Teacher and Trip Leader

Travel, Hotel & Staying in Touch

The five days at a glance, then how students are supervised from the moment they board on Wednesday until you pick them up on Sunday morning.



Washington, DC
April 14 to 18, 2027

Five days at a glance

Sites can change their hours or close at short notice; the learning goals stay the same

Wed, April 14	Report to school 4:30 a.m.; bus leaves 5:00. Three rest stops, lunch on the way. Hotel about 1:35 p.m.; orientation, dinner, early lights-out.
Thu, April 15	National Archives program, U.S. Capitol tour, Library of Congress and the Supreme Court from outside. Dinner, then back to the hotel by 6:45 p.m.
Fri, April 16	National Museum of African American History and Culture, National Museum of American History, then an evening walk to the World War II, Vietnam Veterans, Lincoln and Korean War memorials. Hotel 9:30 p.m.
Sat, April 17	Arlington National Cemetery, National Portrait Gallery, Lafayette Square and the White House from outside. Dinner and closing seminar at the hotel. Bus leaves 9:00 p.m.
Sun, April 18	Overnight bus with four rest stops. Back at school between 5:45 and 6:15 a.m. Students are released only to an adult on your pickup list.

On the bus

- Students sit in assigned seats with their chaperone group and keep seat belts fastened whenever seated.
- On the way out we stop at about 6:40, 9:05 and 11:35 a.m. On the way home we stop at about 10:10 p.m., 12:05, 2:15 and 4:50 a.m.
- At every stop, groups get off and back on together with their chaperone, and staff count before the bus moves. No student is ever alone in a rest area.
- Overnight, two chaperones are awake at all times and the bus is quiet from 10:00 p.m. Students sleep in their seats; a small travel pillow and blanket help.

At the hotel

- Students share triple rooms on two corridors, with a chaperone room on each corridor. Rooming groups are set by the school in March.
- Staff check rooms and give out medications at 8:45 p.m.; lights-out is 9:30 p.m. (10:00 p.m. on Friday after the memorials).
- Students stay on their floor after room check, keep doors closed, and do not use the pool, the fitness room or any exterior door.
- One accessible room is held for any student who becomes unwell.

Staying in touch

- Jordan Patel sends a short update to all families when the group arrives on Wednesday, each evening, and after the last rest stop on Sunday morning.
- For anything urgent during the trip, call Jordan Patel at school, 216-555-0142. Emily Carter's trip phone is 216-555-0164.
- Students may use their phones on the bus and at the hotel until lights-out. Phones are put away during programs, ceremonies and head counts.
- If we ever need to reach you about your student, we call the numbers on your permission slip. Please keep them current.

Sunday morning pickup

- Please be reachable from 5:30 a.m. Jordan Patel will message the arrival time after the last rest stop.
- Students are released only to an adult named on your permission slip. Nobody walks home or takes a rideshare.
- If you are delayed, your student waits inside with two chaperones and we call you.

Cost and payment

\$875 per student covers the bus, three hotel nights, all meals from Wednesday lunch to the Sunday-morning snack, and program materials. Every site we visit is free. Please return the \$250 deposit with the permission slip by Friday, February 26, and the \$625 balance by Friday, March 12. Families who would like help with the cost can speak in confidence with Jordan Patel.



Washington, DC
April 14 to 18, 2027

Packing List & Student Agreement

One suitcase or duffel that fits under the bus, one backpack that stays with the student. Label everything.

Packing list

Mid-April in Washington: usually 50s to 70s °F, with a good chance of one rainy day and cool evenings

- ☐ Broken-in, closed-toe walking shoes (we walk 4 to 6 miles a day)
- ☐ Four daytime outfits plus one spare layer
- ☐ Sweatshirt or fleece for the evening memorials
- ☐ Compact rain jacket or poncho
- ☐ Sleepwear, underwear and socks for four days
- ☐ Comfortable travel clothes for the overnight bus
- ☐ Toiletries in a leakproof bag
- ☐ Refillable water bottle
- ☐ Small backpack (it must pass security: no food or drink inside museums)
- ☐ Field journal and two pencils
- ☐ Phone and charger, if your student carries one
- ☐ Travel pillow and light blanket for the bus
- ☐ Up to \$40 spending money for gift shops; the school covers all meals
- ☐ School-issued trip card with the trip leader's number and the hotel address

Health and medication

Rachel Morgan, RN, our school nurse, travels with the group and carries every student's health form. If your student needs medication on the trip, bring it in its original container with the school's medication form to the nurse's office by 3:30 p.m. on Tuesday, April 13. Tell us by February 26 about any allergy, dietary need, mobility or sensory need, or health change so we can plan for it with the hotel, the meal vendors and each site.

Leave at home

Large or hard-shell luggage; speakers; gaming systems; glass containers; energy drinks; valuables; prank items; pocketknives, aerosols or anything else that will fail security screening; and anything the school or a site does not allow. Students do not need a passport or ID.

If a student is unwell before the trip

Call Emily Carter before 4:00 a.m. on Wednesday. A student who becomes unwell during the trip is cared for by the school nurse and, if needed, seen at a local emergency department; the school calls you right away and a chaperone stays with your student throughout.

Student agreement

Students sign the agreement on the permission slip. It says:

- **Respect the places.** I follow the rules of every museum, memorial, cemetery, hotel and security checkpoint, and I keep my voice down at places of loss and service.
- **Respect the group.** I stay with my chaperone and my buddy, I am on time, I take part in every head count, and I never leave a site, the hotel or a rest stop on my own.
- **Respect the learning.** I complete my journal at each site, I listen to points of view different from mine, and I put my phone away when asked.

Serious or repeated conduct concerns lead to closer supervision and a call home. When safety requires it, a family may be asked to collect their student early at the family's expense, under school policy.

Permission Slip & Health Update

Washington, DC Civic Journey · April 14 to 18, 2027 · Return to the school office with the \$250 deposit by Friday, February 26.



Washington, DC
April 14 to 18, 2027

Student name	Homeroom	Date of birth
Parent or guardian name	Cell phone	
Second parent, guardian or emergency contact	Cell phone	

Permission

- ☐ My student has permission to travel to Washington, DC with Horizon Ridge School of Cleveland from April 14 to 18, 2027.
- ☐ My student will not take part.

I have read the family letter. I understand that the bus leaves school at 5:00 a.m. Wednesday, that the group stays three nights at the Holiday Inn Washington–College Park, that the group travels home overnight on Saturday with rest stops, and that students are released on Sunday morning only to an adult named below.

Health, diet and access

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ The health information the school holds for my student is current. | ☐ I am attaching an update. |
| ☐ My student needs no medication on the trip. | ☐ My student needs medication; the school's medication form is attached. |
| ☐ No dietary accommodation is needed. | ☐ Dietary needs (please describe):
_____ |
| ☐ No mobility, sensory or other access arrangement is needed. | ☐ Please call me to plan an access arrangement. |

Emergency care

If I cannot be reached, I authorize the school staff to obtain emergency medical evaluation and treatment for my student, consistent with school policy and the health information on file. I understand that staff call 911 when urgent care is needed and follow the direction of emergency responders, and that the school will contact me as soon as it can.

Health insurance carrier and member ID (optional)	Family physician and phone (optional)
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Sunday morning pickup

Adults who may collect your student at school

Authorized adult 1	Cell phone
Authorized adult 2	Cell phone

Signatures

Parent or guardian: I give the permission above and confirm the health information is accurate.

Parent or guardian signature	Date
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Student: I have read the student agreement (Family Trip Brief, page 3) and I will keep it.

Student signature	Date
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Once completed, this page contains personal and health information. Return it to the school office in a sealed envelope, not by email. The school files it with the trip records.